

Operation Uptime: 100 maintenance hires for Giga Berlin by 31 December

To: Head of Talent Acquisition, Giga Berlin-Brandenburg · From: Joveo strategist (Bangalore) · Hypothetical case. Every number ties to the attached model (Operation_Uptime_Model.xlsx), and every assumption is labelled on its Assumptions tab.

Summary for the client (Part 5)

Target: 100 signed contracts (30 electricians, 45 mechatronics, 15 automation, 10 supervisors) between 20 Oct and 31 Dec. Start dates can be in 2027.

Recommended budget: €47,500. That is €38.7k of planned spend plus an €8.8k reserve that we release only on results. Expected media cost per hire: ~€387 planned and ≤€475 if the reserve is used. This excludes Joveo fees and your internal costs.

The real constraint: Your recruiters' 55 assessments a week are the limit, not money. Applications become signed contracts in ~3 weeks, and few contracts get signed in Christmas week, so the last useful application is Fri 27 Nov (Fri 20 Nov for supervisors). Between Thu 22 Oct and Tue 1 Dec there are ~322 assessment slots. The plan needs ~291 qualified applicants, so 90% of the slots are used, with weeks 2–5 at 53 of 55. Spending more doesn't add hires before 31 Dec; better-quality applicants and more slots do.

Plan: Every paid channel gets a €750 test in weeks 1–2; those applicants are real candidates and are counted. After that we buy hires from the cheapest source first and pace arrivals at ≤55 qualified a week. Roughly in order of cost per hire: (1) free channels (Tesla careers, BA Jobbörse, Google for Jobs); (2) re-engage past qualified applicants in your ATS (≈€20 per hire); (3) a Polish border corridor for mechatronics with a Polish-speaking pre-screener (≈€230 per hire, within the 40% cap); (4) a 'Handwerk → Industrie' campaign that turns construction electricians into plant electricians; (5) targeted LinkedIn and Google Search, referrals, and one StepStone ad to close the gaps. Paid spend stops after 27 Nov.

Role	Hires	Qualified (plan)	Apps (plan)	Spend	Cost per hire	Main sources (hires)
Electricians	30	99	643	€19.9k	€664	Handwerk → Industrie 11.6 · rediscovery 4.4 · referrals 4.2 · Google 3.9 · organic 3.9 · tests/StepStone 2.1
Mechatronics	45	105	494	€5.5k	€123	organic 14.6 · Polish corridor 13.8 · rediscovery 8.4 · tests 8.2
Automation	15	50	253	€6.7k	€447	LinkedIn 8.6 · rediscovery 2.4 · organic 2.3 · tests 1.6
Supervisors	10	36	221	€6.6k	€655	LinkedIn 5.4 · rediscovery 1.5 · organic 1.3 · Google 1.0 · other 0.9
Total	100	291	1,611	€38.7k	€387	+ €8.8k reserve = €47.5k

How sure am I: ~60% that we sign all 100 by 31 Dec, and ~85% that we sign at least 90. In the case where pass or acceptance rates come in 30% below plan, we sign ~78. The percentages are my own judgement, based on the 90% slot use and the sensitivity test in Part 1.

Smaller budget: With 30% less (€33.25k), we sign ~91: all mechatronics, ~14 automation, ~23 electricians and ~8 supervisors. Electricians fall short first, and they're the role that keeps the lines running, so I advise against the cut.

Top three risks and what I'll do

- **1. Capacity, not money.** Assessment capacity is 90% used. If pass or acceptance rates are 30% worse, we can reach only ~78 hires. → Mix toward pre-screened sources (rediscovery, referrals, Polish pre-screener), tighten the knock-out questions, pace each week at ≤55, and ask you for 10–15 extra slots a week in weeks 2–6. At 65 slots a week, use drops to ~76%.
- **2. Electrician supply.** ~12 of the 30 depend on you accepting construction electricians (Elektroniker EGT + Elektrofachkraft + 2 years) with an in-house bridge. → I need a decision by Fri 23 Oct. If it's no, the money moves to StepStone (up to 2 more ads) and programmatic for electricians at ~€1,000–1,500 per hire, and we expect ~3–5 fewer electricians.
- **3. Christmas and offer speed.** Late offers or hesitant candidates push signatures past 18 Dec. → Offers within 3 days of interview, e-signature, an 'offer valid 7 days' clause, all paid spend stopped after 27 Nov, and acceptance tracked weekly from week 4.

What I need from you

(1) 55 assessments a week from Thu 22 Oct to Tue 1 Dec, plus 10–15 extra if possible. (2) A day-1 ATS export of past qualified applicants for these titles, with GDPR consent confirmed, and source tags (utm) carried into the ATS. (3) Approval of a €1,000 referral bonus and one internal message to maintenance staff. (4) Your EGT-electrician

decision by 23 Oct. (5) A 3-day offer turnaround and e-signature until 18 Dec. (6) Budget approval of €47.5k, with the reserve released by the rules in Part 4.

Part 1: Funnel

Role	App → qualified	Qualified → passed	Passed → offer	Offer → signed	Qualified signed →	Qualified needed	Applications needed
Electricians	15%	55%	90%	65%	32%	93	622
Mechatronics	22%	60%	90%	75%	41%	111	505
Automation	12%	50%	90%	65%	29%	51	427
Supervisors	10%	45%	85%	70%	27%	37	373
Total					34%	293	1,927

Where the rates come from. All rates are my own estimates, each with one line of reasoning on the Assumptions tab. Share qualified is low because the brief says most applicants fail the requirements; for electricians, foreign-trained applicants can't be recognised in time (2–4 months, \$6 BQFG). Pass rates assume a practical test about half fail. Acceptance reflects counter-offers in Engpass trades; an offer above the Brandenburg median (€3,030/month, WSI Lohnspiegel, standardised to 10 years' experience) would help, and pay bands are for the client to confirm. The channel mix in Part 2 needs 291 qualified and 1,611 applications (16% fewer applications), because the initiatives bring better-screened candidates.

Capacity check. Assessment → interview 7 days, → offer 3 days, → signature 7 days, and supervisors add a round (+7 days). With the last realistic signature on Fri 18 Dec, the last useful application is 27 Nov (E/M/A) and 20 Nov (supervisors). $55 \times 41 \text{ days} \div 7 = 322$ slots against 291 qualified: 90% use. Week 1 is 38 of 39 slots, weeks 2–5 are 53 of 55, and week 6 is 41.

Hardest role: Electricians. They are the largest scarce block (30), with channel capacity of 1.9× the openings, but only 1.5× without the unproven construction-electrician initiative (I2). That is the lowest of any role (mechatronics 3.2×, automation 2.0×, supervisors 1.8×). There is no Polish route and no foreign-trained route by 31 Dec, and energy/grid, rail, aerospace and agencies all want the same certificate. Supervisors need a bigger share of a smaller pool (17% of reachable people vs 9% for electricians), but they're only 10 hires and have an internal-promotion fallback.

Most sensitive assumption: Qualified → signed (assessment pass rate, and equally offer acceptance). If it is 30% worse, the plan needs 415 qualified applicants for 322 slots (129%), so at most ~78 hires are possible whatever the budget. Media would also rise ~43%. A 30% worse share qualified or cost per application only costs money (+43% / +30%), and a 30% cut in capacity also gives ~78. This is why the first check after week 2 is pass rates.

Part 2: Channels and budget

Method. For each role, sources are ranked by cost per hire at full capacity: (cost per application × applications + fixed set-up) ÷ hires, where hires = applications × share qualified × qualified-to-signed rate. Every paid CPC/CPA cell first gets a €750 test in weeks 1–2. Those ~313 applications, ~46 qualified and ~16 expected hires are counted in the plan. The model then fills the remaining need with the cheapest source first, up to each source's realistic volume. The Polish 40% cap is built into the corridor's capacity, and StepStone is bought in whole €1,449 ads. Each source's realistic volume is checked against the reachable talent pool (Pool tab).

Channel (why)	Electricians	Mechatronics	Automation	Supervisors
Organic: careers, BA Jobbörse, Google for Jobs (free, brand pull)	€0 / €0 · 3.9	€0 / €0 · 14.6	€0 / €0 · 2.3	€0 / €0 · 1.3
I1a ATS rediscovery (already screened)	€8 / €23 · 4.4	€8 / €18 · 8.4	€8 / €25 · 2.4	€8 / €27 · 1.5
I3 Polish corridor + pre-screen (40% cap)	–	€89 / €228 · 13.8	–	–
Meta lead ads (passive blue-collar reach)	€360 / €1,119 · 0.7 T	€100 / €247 · 3.0 T	–	–
Programmatic (Indeed, Joooble, Talent.com...)	€476 / €1,480 · 0.5 T	€109 / €269 · 2.8 T	€375 / €1,282 · 0.6 T	€425 / €1,587 · 0.5 T
Google Search (high intent, low volume)	€210 / €651 · 3.9	€126 / €310 · 2.4 T	€210 / €716 · 1.0 T	€262 / €978 · 1.0
LinkedIn (PLC/TIA and Meister live here)	–	–	€175 / €598 · 8.6	€219 / €817 · 5.4
I2 Handwerk → Industrie (new pool)	€200 / €881 · 11.6	–	–	–
I1b Referrals (€1,000 bonus on hire)	€370 / €1,000 · 4.2	€466 / €1,000 · –	€336 / €1,000 · –	€308 / €1,000 · 0.4
StepStone (German, CV-based, €1,449 per ad)	€322 / €1,001 · 0.9	€166 / €409 · –	€386 / €1,321 · –	€386 / €1,443 · –

Cells show cost per qualified / cost per hire · hires planned (T = the €750 test only). Cost per hire includes set-up costs (I2 €1,200, I3 €400 translation). The single StepStone ad works out at €1,583 per hire because it is bought whole. Paid cost per application ranges from €12 (Polish boards; €19.50 with the pre-screen call) to €97 (StepStone, at 15 applications per ad); rediscovery costs €4. Sources: StepStone €1,449 per ad (instaffo.com), Pracuj.pl ~1,499 PLN per ad, indicative (dlafirm.pracuj.pl), Indeed CPC \$0.10–5+ (pin.com), LinkedIn CPC \$4–8 (peoplebox.ai), Appcast apply rate 6.1% (2025 benchmark). All other figures are my own estimates.

What the ranking says. For mechatronics, programmatic, Meta and Search run only their tests, because free sources, rediscovery and the Polish corridor (€228 per hire) cover the need. Together they have ~80 more hires of capacity at €247–310, so the reserve goes there first if organic or Polish volume falls short. Electricians are the opposite: beyond the first ~8 hires (organic and rediscovery), every source costs €650–1,500.

Allocation. €38.7k planned = €20.4k paid channels (including €9.0k of tests: €750 in each of 12 paid cells) + €16.7k initiative media, pre-screen calls and referral bonuses + €1.6k set-up. The reserve is €8.8k: 15% of the €45.6k calculated total (€6.8k) plus €1.9k from rounding up to €47.5k. It stays unallocated until week 3. Spend after tests follows 6%, 12%, 21%, 21%, 21%, 19% across weeks 1–6 (Tue–Mon); weeks 1–2 are low because the tests already fill those slots. Supervisor spend ends in week 5. StepStone and set-up are paid in week 1, tests across weeks 1–2, and referral bonuses as hires sign (weeks 4–9). Weeks 1–2 cash is €16.2k (34%), of which €9.0k is tests. From Mon 2 Nov we cut planned cells that break the rules once they pass €500 or 30 applications; tests and the full re-allocation are judged by Mon 9 Nov.

With less money. The most expensive cost-per-hire cells are cut first, including their tests and set-up, and the reserve stays at 15%. At –15% (€40.4k) we sign ~97; at –30% (€33.25k) ~91, with electricians at 23, automation at 14 and supervisors at 8; at –50% (€23.75k) ~82. Mechatronics never falls short. What I'd tell the client: the last €14.25k buys ~9 hires at ~€1,550 each, mostly electricians, the role that keeps the lines running. If you must cut, cover supervisors with internal promotions and protect electricians.

Part 3: New sources (all funded inside the €47.5k)

	I1 Talent rediscovery + referral sprint	I2 'Vom Handwerk in die Industrie' (hardest role)	I3 Polish border corridor + pre-screener
Who / where	~700 past applicants in your ATS who were qualified but not hired; ~1,000 plant technicians as referrers	~12,000 construction electricians (Elektroniker EGT) within 75 km, many of whom see site work slow in winter (my assumption)	Mechatronics/Industriemechanik in Ślubice, Kostrzyn, Gorzów, Zielona Góra (60–130 km, EU, no visa)
How it works	Personal DE email + SMS in 3 waves (days 2, 7, 14) with a 1-click re-apply link. Referral link + €1,000 bonus on a signed hire	Meta + Google ads 'Vom Baustellen-Winter in die Gigafactory: Schichtzulage, Festvertrag'. 6-question quiz (Gesellenbrief, Elektrofachkraft, shifts, language, commute). Tesla runs a 2–4 week industrial bridge	Polish ads on Pracuj.pl, OLX Praca and Polish-geo Meta. A remote Polish-speaking freelancer (paid hourly, ~15 min per applicant) phones every applicant, checks German/English and shift acceptance, and hands over only qualified ones
Why it beats usual channels	Already screened (50% qualified vs 5–35% on paid channels), already wanted Tesla, nearly free (€4 per application)	Reaches a certified electrical pool that doesn't search 'Betriebsstechnik' jobs; roughly doubles the hardest role's pool	Polish job seekers mostly search Polish boards, not German ones. The pre-screen raises the pass rate and saves your 55 slots
Cost → output	€350 messaging + €4.6k bonuses → 84 re-applications + 28 referrals, ~55 qualified, ~21 hires (–€21 per hire for rediscovery, €1,000 for referrals)	300 apps × €30 = €9.0k + €1.2k set-up → 45 qualified × 25.7% = 11.6 hires (€881 per hire)	141 apps × (€12 ads + €7.50 call) = €2.7k + €0.4k translation → 31 qualified × 44.6% = 13.8 hires (31% of mechatronics, under the 40% cap; €228 per hire)
2-week test	€350 of messaging (bonuses are paid only on signed hires, from week 4). Works if ≥15 qualified (≥5 electricians) by day 14; ~30 are expected. Kill: <5 qualified → stop the waves; the bonus stays because it costs only on a hire	€2.8k (€1.2k set-up + €1.6k media). Works if ≥6 qualified at ≤€250 each by day 14 (plan ≈8 at €200), and in week 4 ≥50% of the first 6 interviewed pass. Kill: >€400 per qualified or profile rejected (day 14), or <40% pass (week 4) → money to StepStone/programmatic	€1.0k. Works if ≥5 qualified at ≤€90 each by day 14 (plan ≈7 at €89). Kill: <3 qualified or <30% pass the language check → stop ads and the freelancer's hours
Who does what (from Bangalore)	Me: segment the export and send wave 1 on day 2 (Wed 21 Oct); waves 2–3 copy and tracked links ready by day 3. Client: ATS export + consent check, bonus approval, one intranet/shift-briefing message	Me: audiences, quiz funnel, brief a remote DE copywriter (€700), live by Fri 23 Oct. Client: profile sign-off by 23 Oct, bridge plan, pay line for the ad	Me: post ads (day 3), hire the freelancer via Joveo's vendor pool/Useme (live 27 Oct), write script and scorecard, daily 15-min call at 09:00 German time (13:30 IST). Client: approve PL ads, shift/commute facts, a German/English interviewer

Which could become a Joveo product: I1a ATS rediscovery. Every large employer has thousands of previously screened candidates sitting in its ATS, and in my experience they are rarely re-marketed to. Here they cost ~€20 per hire against €220–1,600 for other sources, and they're available on day 1 when paid channels are still warming up. That is exactly when the 55 slots would otherwise sit empty. Joveo already matches jobs to supply programmatically. Adding a 'rediscovery' source that matches open reqs to past qualified applicants, re-contacts them with consent and tracks them to hire through the same source tags is a repeatable product priced per qualified applicant, and it works in any market without local staff. The Polish corridor is the second candidate, as a reusable cross-border supply lane with pay-per-call pre-screening.

Part 4: Running it week by week

Track. Every Monday, by source × role: spend, clicks, applications, qualified, assessed, interviewed, passed, offers, signed, cost per qualified, cost per hire, days in stage, and slot use (assessed vs 55). Data comes from the Joveo platform (spend, clicks, applies by tracked URL), a Monday ATS export with the utm source carried into the ATS source field, recruiter disposition codes, and the Polish pre-screener's sheet. A report goes out every Tuesday. The Tracker tab turns actuals into decisions and a hire forecast automatically.

Money rules. No judgement before €500 or 30 applications in a cell; tests run to €750. Updated share qualified = $(\text{actual qualified} + 30 \times \text{plan}) \div (\text{actual applications} + 30)$. Re-forecast cost per qualified $\leq 0.8 \times$ plan with free slots → add 25% a week from the reserve. $\geq 1.5 \times$ → cut 50%. $\geq 2 \times$ plan, or €750 spent with zero qualified → switch off. Capacity overrides everything: if next week's forecast is above 55 qualified, pause the most expensive cells first; if it is below 45, release reserve to the cheapest cells with headroom.

End-of-week-2 checks (Mon 2 Nov, confirmed Mon 9 Nov):

- **Qualified → pass rate by role.** Read on the week-1 cohort, whose interviews run 29 Oct–2 Nov. This is the most sensitive assumption. If it is below 45% across roles: tighten knock-out questions, add pre-screen calls for electricians, ask for +10 slots a week, and shift spend toward rediscovery, referrals and StepStone. Re-run the model with the actual rate to show the client the new ceiling.
- **Electrician share qualified and I2's day-14 result.** If the EGT profile is rejected or I2 is below 10% qualified, move I2 and reserve money into StepStone (up to 2 more ads) and programmatic for electricians, and tell the client to expect ~25–27 electricians.
- **Paid-channel costs and share qualified.** Compare the 12 tests' cost per application and share qualified with plan. Re-rank the cells by entering the updated values on Assumptions §7; the cheapest ones with capacity get the reserve from week 3.

Week-4 check. Offer acceptance and speed can't be read until signatures start in week 4 (10 Nov). On Mon 16 Nov: if acceptance is below 55% or offer → signature takes more than 10 days, pull the cut-off a week earlier, move spend into weeks 4–5, and propose a signing bonus for contracts signed before 18 Dec.

First five things in week 1:

1. Tue 20 Oct, 09:00 CEST (12:30 IST): kick-off with your TA lead. Lock the 55 slots and hiring steps, the 18 Dec signing date, the referral bonus, the EGT decision and utm → ATS source tagging. Request the ATS export.
2. Tue–Wed: launch every planned cell and the €750 tests with tracked URLs and knock-out questions (careers/BA/Google for Jobs check, Google Search, LinkedIn, Meta, programmatic, 1 StepStone ad for electricians).
3. Wed 21 Oct: rediscovery wave 1 and referral launch, so recruiters have qualified candidates to assess from Thu 22 Oct.
4. Wed–Fri: Polish ads live and freelancer contracted (starts Tue 27 Oct). I2 quiz funnel and creative live by Fri 23 Oct.
5. Mon 26 Oct: first tracker read-out. Check week-2 qualified volume against 55, confirm the assessment calendar, and line up the 2 Nov decisions.